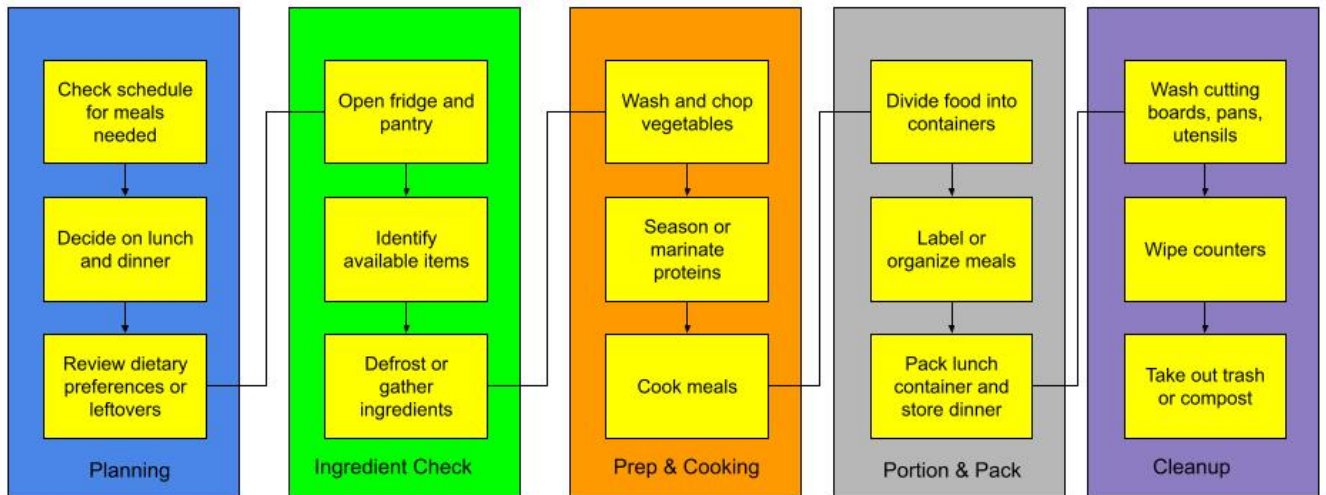


Nima Memarzadeh Module 5.2 Assignment

Optimizing My Daily Meal Prep Routine Using Value Stream Mapping



Estimated Average Flow Time

Stage	Estimated Time
Planning	10 mins
Ingredient Check	5 mins
Prep & Cooking	35 mins
Portion & Pack	10 mins
Cleanup	15 mins

Estimated Cycle Time: 1.25 hrs (75mins)

Optimizing My Daily Meal Prep Routine

Eliminating Waste:

I can eliminate the few extra minutes spent chopping vegetables in the morning by preparing them the night before and storing them in airtight containers. I've also considered batch-cooking staples like rice or pasta ahead of time, which would remove the need to cook those fresh each day and save around 10–15 minutes. Using just one pan or baking sheet for both meals, whenever possible, reduces the number of dishes and simplifies cleanup. To further reduce waste, I keep a reusable meal plan template that I can adjust daily without starting from scratch.

Workflow Orchestration:

I've started cooking proteins while prepping vegetables to better use overlapping time. For example, while the chicken is baking, I chop vegetables or begin portioning out the lunch container. If dinner needs time to cool, I use that window to pack lunch and fill my water bottle. I'm also considering rearranging the flow slightly, such as packing containers first before starting cleanup, so I don't risk needing clean utensils mid-process. These small adjustments can make the whole routine more continuous and less stop-and-go.

Governance Models:

To maintain consistency, I use a checklist that covers every major step, from turning on the stove to putting away utensils. I've noticed that skipping even one task early on can delay the entire morning, so I've made the checklist visible on the fridge. Additionally, I maintain a small set of labeled containers that are always washed and ready the night before, ensuring I don't scramble for missing items. Finally, I've blocked out a fixed time on my morning calendar dedicated just to food prep, to avoid overlapping it with other responsibilities and reduce decision fatigue.